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A photo essay on autocratic politics and the suppression of thought — the first resource any authoritarian strips from a people is not dignity but the capacity for independent thinking. Photographs and text by Kanika Solanki, journalism student at the University of Delhi.

BY KANIKA SOLANKI

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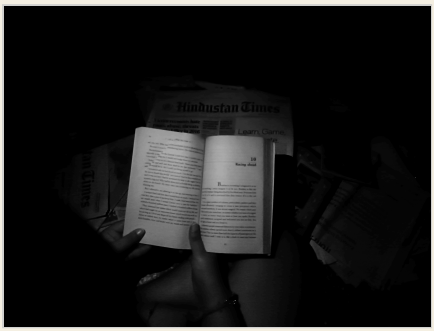
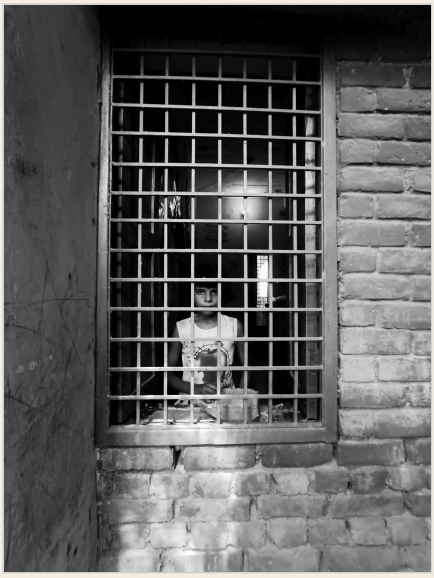
The identifying trait of autocratic politics, the most *elementary* means of taking control of a people, is cutting out their resources. And the first of these to go, perhaps even before dignity & survival, is thought. And the capacity to hold on to it.





> *Kanika Solanki is currently a student at the University of Delhi, pursuing her bachelor's in journalism. She has a keen interest in photography and graphic designing & has previously interned as a content writer. The quest for gaining new information and experiences keeps her going.*

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